ECON 003: Introduction to Microeconomics

Instructional Team

Instructor: Che Li

Email: che.li@email.ucr.edu

Office Hours (Zoom): Wednesday, 2:00–4:00 PM, or by appointment

Teaching Assistants:

Name	Email	Office Hours (Zoom)

Course Description and Learning Outcomes

This course introduces the fundamental principles of microeconomics, focusing on individual and firm decision-making and how those decisions shape market outcomes and the allocation of resources. Topics include supply and demand, consumer behavior, production and costs, market structure, international trade, externalities and public goods, and government intervention in cases of market failure. Students will apply economic reasoning to real-world questions involving pricing, taxation, and public policy.

Required Materials

MyLab Economics — REQUIRED. All homework assignments and quizzes are administered through MyLab Economics. You must obtain access by the end of Week 1. Access is available directly through **Canvas>Access Pearson**. Registration support instructions are also available on Canvas.

Textbook. Microeconomics, 3rd edition, by Daron Acemoglu, David Laibson, and John A. List (Pearson, 2022). Lectures follow the book closely, and students who read alongside the lectures consistently perform better.

Course Format and Weekly Rhythm

There are no scheduled live meetings. Lecture recordings and accompanying materials are posted to Canvas on the following schedule:

- Monday-Tuesdays — first lecture of the week posted.
- Tuesdays— second lecture of the week posted.

You are expected to watch each week's lectures and complete all assessments by the posted deadlines. Two chapters are covered each week.

Discussion sections. TAs will help you with your homework, review exam problems, and will hold regular office hours. Engaging with section materials is strongly encouraged — they are the closest thing this course has to guided practice.

Grading

Category	Percentage
Homework Assignments (MyLab)	20%

Quizzes (MyLab)	15%
Midterm Exam	30%
Final Exam	35%
Total	**100%**

Extra credit may be offered at the instructor's discretion.

Grading Scale

A+: 97–100%	A: 93–96%	A–: 90–92%
B+: 87–89%	B: 83–86%	B–: 80–82%
C+: 77–79%	C: 73–76%	C–: 70–72%
D+: 67–69%	D: 63–66%	D–: 60–62%
F: Below 60%		

Homework and Quizzes

Homework (20%). One MyLab homework assignment per week. Assignments are due **Sundays at 11:59 PM, with the exception of Week 5**. You will have unlimited attempts before the deadline. Late submissions receive a 50% deduction. **Week 5 assignments are all due on Friday, 11:59PM.**

Quizzes (15%). One MyLab quiz per week, released weekly alongside the lectures and due on the same deadline as that week's homework. You will have two attempts on each quiz. Quizzes are stricter than homework so I recommend you complete your homework first.

Exams

Exam	Date	Time	Coverage
Midterm	Saturday, August 15	10:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Chapters 1, 3, 4, 5, 6
Final	Saturday, August 29	10:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Cumulative — all chapters

The final exam replaces the midterm if it is higher. If your final exam score exceeds your midterm score, your final exam score will replace your midterm score, and the final will effectively count for 65% of your grade. Please note that this policy runs in one direction only: **the final may replace the midterm, but the midterm will never replace the final.**

Make-up exams. Make-up exams are granted only for documented time conflicts, and you must notify the instructor **at least one week in advance** so that an alternative time can be scheduled. Requests made after the exam has taken place will not be accommodated.

Documented emergencies. If a genuine emergency prevents you from sitting the final exam and advance notice was impossible, contact the instructor as soon as you are able, with documentation. Such cases will be

handled individually and may result in a grade of Incomplete, to be resolved under university policy.

Exam delivery. Both exams are administered online. Detailed instructions, including any proctoring requirements, will be announced on Canvas at least one week before each exam.

Academic Integrity

As a student in this class, it is your responsibility to act with integrity and accountability. For this course, the essential rule is this: you may collaborate with classmates and use outside resources, including AI tools, on homework assignments and quizzes. You may not use unapproved outside resources or communicate with anyone during exams.

Your conduct affirms the integrity of the University and the degree it represents. Should you commit academic misconduct in this course, you may receive a failing grade, and the case may be reported to Student Conduct and Academic Integrity Programs (SCAIP), where you will be held accountable according to University policy.

For more information, visit conduct.ucr.edu/policies/academicintegrity.html.

Student Support and Accommodations

Student Disability Resource Center (SDRC). UC Riverside is committed to providing equal access to learning opportunities to students with documented disabilities. To ensure access to this class, please contact the SDRC to begin a confidential conversation about requesting accommodations. More information is available at sdrc.ucr.edu. If you are registered with the SDRC, please send your accommodation letter to the instructor through the SDRC portal at the start of the session.

Office of Civil Rights. Your experience at UCR should be free of bias, discrimination, and harassment. The Office of Civil Rights is your resource for reporting such issues, at civilrights@ucr.edu or titleix.ucr.edu/contact-us.

Confidential resources. Please note that anything you disclose to the instructor related to bias, discrimination, or harassment may need to be reported to the Office of Civil Rights. UCR does maintain confidential resources, including CARE, CAPS, and the University Ombuds. See help.ucr.edu/resources.

Course Schedule

Lectures post Tuesdays and Wednesdays. Homework and quizzes are due Sundays at 11:59 PM, except in Week 5.

Week	Chapters	Due Dates and Exams
Week 1 Jul 27 – Aug 2	Ch. 1 — Principles and Practice of Economics Ch. 3 — Optimization	HW + Quizzes 1, 3 due Sun, Aug 2
Week 2 Aug 3 – 9	Ch. 4 — Demand, Supply, and Equilibrium Ch. 5 — Consumers and Incentives	HW + Quizzes 4, 5 due Sun, Aug 9
Week 3 Aug 10 – 16	Ch. 6 — Sellers and Incentives Ch. 7 — Perfect Competition and the Invisible Hand	**MIDTERM EXAM** **Sat, Aug 15, 10 AM – 12 PM** Covers Ch. 1, 3, 4, 5, 6 HW + Quizzes 6, 7 due Sun, Aug 16
Week 4 Aug 17 – 23	Ch. 8 — Trade Ch. 9 — Externalities and Public Goods	HW + Quizzes 8, 9 due Sun, Aug 23
Week 5 Aug 24 – 29	Ch. 10 — Taxation and Regulation Ch. 12 — Monopoly	HW + Quizzes 10, 12 **due Fri, Aug 28** **FINAL EXAM** **Sat, Aug 29, 10 AM – 12 PM** Cumulative